Girona Gav

21

BDT 2010 · Girona · Featuring Gav, Hursty & Fred

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2010 welcomed two Tour virgins, Fred and Gav. Both have since gone on to make significant contributions to the tour, including captaining the Retrievers, but it would be fair to say that Gav made an inauspicious start to touring life.



The OC Theatre and The Judge!

His first mistake was booking a separate flight to the group and arriving significantly later than the rest of us, a clear breach of the tour rules, which led to accusations that he was perhaps not taking the tour sufficiently seriously, particularly as he was a virgin who should be looking to impress!

During Gav's absence at the OC, this was discussed at length with the conclusion reached that we should treat this lack of respect by greeting Gav with utter disdain when he entered the OC theatre. When he burst into the room full of beans, but very late, the total silence he received completely unnerved him, particularly given he had not even met half the Dogs before! A cruel start!

Things did not improve much for Gav from there. As he took his seat, he was immediately made to stand again and to his surprise was mercilessly fined by Judge Monkey for being late, despite having stumped up €100+ for his own personal cab from the airport in his rush to join us.



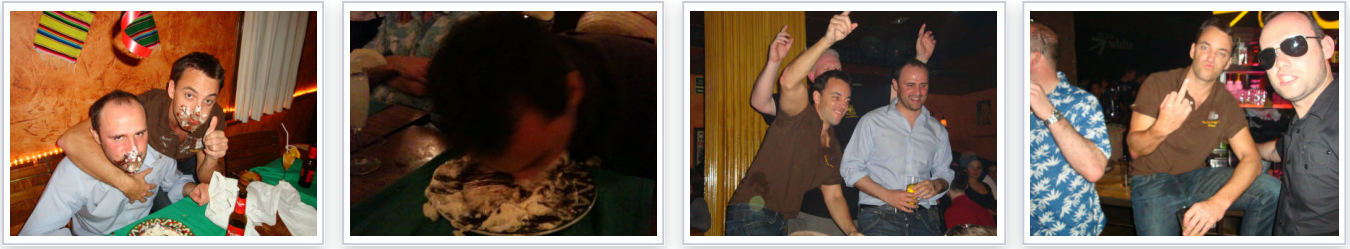
Night I

The next target was his attire. To no-one's surprise, Gav was wearing a smart and expensive shirt that first night but that soon changed when he and Fred were ordered by The Judge to replace their shirts with an 'I am a Virgin' T-shirt.

Having reluctantly donned this and still somewhat stunned by the self-generated storm that had materialised, Gav's backside had barely touched his chair again before he and Fred were back on their feet to be formally introduced to the Big Dogs and appropriately inducted by snotting a truly horrible drink.

This concoction in combination with several other drinks clearly affected Gav's golfing form, for the following day we hit the golf course and in his first ever tour round he recorded merely 19 points, the lowest of the day.

That evening, Gav appeared in the hotel lobby in another expensive new shirt but was quickly despatched back to his room to change, as we unveiled the Brown Shitzu jersey (to his absolute delight!). He was also forced into a cake-eating competition for good measure!



Night II

Sadly things had not improved for Gav after Round II, with a 20-point effort meaning that we had to inform him that he would still be wearing the Brown Jersey that evening – again he was simply delighted!



Night III



A memorable first tour for Neilan!

This was an unusual tour in that we only stayed for three nights, the shortest tour to date, and so come the tour's end Gav remarked that he had enjoyed himself hugely but was mildly disappointed not to have been able to wear any of his clothes for the entire duration of the trip! "Welcome to touring life" we responded!

Things could only get better and they must have as he's been back virtually every year since then!